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Helping Ghanaian businesses get seen and get paid

Guide 4: The Currency of Value

Money does not chase wishes. Money chases value. The more problems you solve, the more cash flows to you.

If you started your business just to “make money,” it can be hard to grow. Money is not given out for wishing. It moves toward whoever solves a problem the best. If you want more cash flow, look for ways to solve a bigger problem for the people who already walk into your shop.

Two Ways to See a Customer

There are two ways a business owner can look at the same customer:

- **The Transaction Trap:** seeing a customer only as a wallet. You look at the person and think, “What small amount can I collect from this one sale?”
- **The Value Mindset:** seeing a customer as someone with a bigger problem to solve. You ask, “Why does this person need this? What is really at stake for them?”

Case Study: A Printing Shop

Picture someone who walks into a printing shop to print a CV or a business proposal. They do not just want paper, they want to look sharp and professional, because a job offer or a contract may depend on it.

The Low-Value Way (example)

Print the paper, collect a small fee, say goodbye. The customer's deeper problem looking professional is never addressed.

The High-Value Way (example)

Look at the document and say: “Boss, this proposal looks sharp, but loose paper can get torn or stained on the way there. Let me bind it with a clean cover for a little extra, so it stands out on the manager's desk.” The shop owner has now solved a bigger problem helping the customer look good and earned more from the same visit.



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This Works Beyond Printing

The same idea applies to almost any shop. Look for the real reason behind the purchase, not just the item itself.

Example

A shoe seller notices a customer buying shoes for a job interview. Instead of just selling the shoes, the seller also offers a quick polish and a tip on lacing them neatly because the customer's real goal is to make a strong first impression, not just to own a pair of shoes.

The Big Idea

You do not grow your cash flow by asking customers for more money. You grow it by removing friction and adding convenience or quality to what they already came to buy. When you make life easier for the people around you, more money naturally flows your way.

Try This Today

- Pick your most common product or service. Ask yourself: "What is the customer really trying to achieve when they buy this?"
- Think of one small add-on that would solve that deeper problem (protection, convenience, speed, or appearance).
- Offer that add-on to the next 3 customers and see how many say yes.

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